

TEST LAB

The Wearable GPS

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THE PRODUCT

The **Garmin Fenix GPS Navigator Watch** is one of two hiking and adventure devices on the market with built-in GPS and ABC (altimeter, barometer, compass) systems. It also hooks up to sensors to track physical performance—perfect for runners and cyclists. \$400, Mountain Equipment Co-op, mec.ca



Geocaching

I visit geocaching.com and find several containers hidden within walking distance of my house, so **I connect the Fenix to my laptop** and download the coordinates of one 837 metres away. I switch to compass mode and follow the arrow. Soon, I'm standing on a wooded path. Distance to concealed trinket: 20 metres. Seconds later, I find it tucked between two branches. Easy.

Biking

I attach a sensor to my mountain bike and start pedalling. I keep checking the watch to monitor speed, which seems like a good idea if my goal is to smash my head into a utility pole. Besides, the Fenix has few cycling-specific features—it's not made for serious riders.

Golfing

You can't load course information on the Fenix like you can on GPS watches created especially for golf, but **you can save the coordinates of each putting green**. That's good enough to provide yardages for a hack like me, who mostly plays the same 9-hole tract.

Jogging

Finally, **I strap on a heart-rate monitor**, slip on my running shoes and hit the asphalt. The Fenix tracks how much I'm taxing my ticker, as well as my time, distance, route and even elevation. This would have been great during my marathon days.

BEST FOR Hardcore outdoorsy types who like to wander off the beaten path.
BANG FOR YOUR BUCK High. The Fenix may be pricey, but it's loaded with features. The only other watch that comes close is the Suunto Ambit, and it will put you out an extra \$126.